

Concept Note

The full case for the EECA Lung Health Hub – a phased, evidence-based investment across nine countries in Eastern Europe & Central Asia.

DETAILED INVESTMENT PROPOSAL: THE EECA LUNG HEALTH HUB

From Decision to Delivery: Advancing Political Certainty and Lung Health Security in Eastern Europe and Central Asia

Last updated: September 2026 · Prepared by the EECA Lung Health Hub Team

IN BRIEF: TURNING POLITICAL DECISIONS INTO DELIVERED CARE, FASTER

The **Eastern Europe Central Asia (EECA) Lung Health Hub** is an action-oriented regional platform that helps countries turn political decisions on lung health into real action – faster and more effectively. It focuses on lung health as an entry point for strengthening health systems across Eastern Europe and Central Asia, combining policy intelligence, financing and implementation support.

Rather than creating another standalone initiative, the Hub is designed to work through existing national institutions and regional partnerships, helping countries turn evidence and commitments into funded, operational solutions.

EECA Lung Health Hub works through three connected functions:



Engine

An AI-supported tool that analyses legislation, helps prepare amendments, and speeds up parliamentary work on lung health – with dedicated human oversight ensuring coordination.



Bridge

A platform for direct regional parliamentary cooperation. It identifies common priorities and successful approaches across countries, and makes regional exchange more practical and accessible.



Shield

An early-warning and continuity system that alerts decision-makers to risks that could interrupt treatment, and supports practical measures to reduce differences in access to medicines.

The Hub starts with a *six-month Foundation Phase* in one country to test and prove the model, before expanding regionally. It works through existing institutions rather than creating parallel structures.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY: A CATALYTIC TWO-YEAR PROGRAMME FOR LASTING REGIONAL IMPACT

The Eastern Europe and Central Asia (EECA) region faces a critical juncture. Persistent health epidemics, escalating geopolitical complexities, and a fundamental shift in global health financing demand a new paradigm: rapid, decisive action and national ownership. With major donors scaling back their funding commitments globally – and particularly across EECA since early 2025 – the region must urgently adapt to safeguard its health future.

This proposal focuses on lung health diseases – the leading cause of preventable deaths and a key driver of health system strain across the region, where tuberculosis, chronic respiratory conditions, and post-infection complications continue to threaten population health and economic stability.

This Detailed Investment Proposal outlines a strategic opportunity to support the EECA Lung Health Hub as a full-scale, high-impact program, structured as a phased programme over 2 years: a **6-month Foundation Phase in one EECA country** delivering a fully working solution, followed by country-by-country replication and regional build-out. Full phased budget and terms are available on request.

This Hub is designed as a fast, flexible engine to move from decision to delivery, giving politicians greater certainty and speeding up the rollout of essential lung health policies and services. It tackles the common problem of "too many laws vs. too little implementation." Crucially, the Hub builds on a solid and proven foundation – the established infrastructure and deep relationships of the **Global TB Caucus**, a global network of parliamentarians active in the EECA region since 2014. This existing network, comprising nine active national caucuses (Armenia, Azerbaijan, Georgia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Moldova, Tajikistan, Ukraine, Uzbekistan), provides an unparalleled foundation for rapid, sustainable impact. Building on this political reach and trust, the Hub leverages advanced digital and AI-enabled solutions – including AI-assisted legislative drafting and analysis (with mandatory human review) for MPs and a "Last-Mile Logistics Dashboard" – to shorten the time between decision-making and execution, with the potential to reduce timelines to as little as one week in optimized settings.

Functioning as a **Health Security Coordination Center**, the Hub ensures continuity of care and integrated assistance for approximately 300,000 vulnerable patients across the EECA region affected by TB and other lung diseases (based on WHO and ECDC regional estimates available as of 2025). This is a conservative estimate based on the annual incidence of TB alone in the target countries; the broader scope of lung health diseases and co-morbidities significantly increases the number of beneficiaries.

This proposal details a high-impact pathway to strengthen lung health sovereignty, regional resilience, and sustainable national health systems across EECA – offering national partners, donors and private stakeholders a strategic, measurable, and timely investment in the region's health and stability.

1. THE OPPORTUNITY: NAVIGATING A NEW REALITY WITH URGENCY AND PRECISION

The EECA region is currently facing overlapping health, economic, and geopolitical challenges that demand a strategic and locally-led response.

1.1. Persistent Lung Health Crises: A Focused Imperative

The EECA region bears one of the world's highest burdens of tuberculosis, with 18 high-priority countries accounting for approximately 85% of the TB burden and 99% of the multidrug-resistant TB (MDR-TB) burden. Beyond TB, other critical lung health conditions – such as chronic respiratory diseases and emerging respiratory infections – further strain already fragile health systems. The Hub focuses on lung health diseases, reflecting both their disproportionate burden among key and vulnerable populations and the high potential for impactful, targeted responses.

18

high-priority countries

85%

of the region's TB burden

99%

of MDR-TB burden

1.2. The Global Fund Transition: A Call for National Ownership

Major donors are substantially reducing their active engagement in the EECA region from early 2025 onward. This strategic pivot creates a critical funding gap and underscores the urgent need for EECA countries to transition towards sustainable,

domestically financed health systems. International donors are increasingly advocating for national ownership and the development of robust local funding mechanisms, placing the onus on regional advocates to secure and optimize internal resources. This transition presents a unique opportunity for national donors to step forward and champion a model of self-reliance. This proposal offers a concrete, ready-to-implement pathway to operationalize that shift through practical mechanisms, milestones, and demonstrable regional impact.

1.3. Geopolitical Instability and Health Security: The Unseen Crisis

Escalating geopolitical instability and security threats across the region – including continued full-scale aggression from Russia in Ukraine and other geopolitical threats – compound the crisis. The decline in global health donor spending further exacerbates this vulnerability, particularly as shrinking civic space and new restrictive legislation increasingly threaten people's safety. In the event of escalating conflicts or other geopolitical shocks, the Hub's role as a Health Security Coordination Center becomes paramount, ensuring uninterrupted, coordinated assistance to all affected patients, regardless of the security context. This is a direct investment in regional stability and health security.

1.4. Decision Paralysis and Implementation Lag: The Regional Hesitation

Despite increasing health expenditures in many EECA countries, budgets often do not match the real disease burden because planning is fragmented, spending data are weak, and forecasting is limited. A significant challenge is "regional hesitation" – where political systems struggle to move from commitment to concrete action. It also stems from the overwhelming legislative workload on parliamentarians: with an average MP facing a deluge of legislative acts, the capacity for swift, informed decision-making on complex health policies is severely hampered. This leads to decision paralysis and implementation lag, where critical health policies take months, if not years, to translate into tangible benefits. Without robust data governance, standards, and privacy safeguards (aggregated / non-identifiable data only; ISO 27001-grade security; GDPR-equivalent protection; sovereign / in-region hosting; independent audit), the potential of digital health remains untapped – risking donor skepticism about "AI breakthroughs."

2. THE SOLUTION: THE EECA LUNG HEALTH HUB

The EECA Lung Health Hub is designed as a lean, high-impact Full-Scale Program, strategically focused on catalyzing political will, community empowerment, and data-driven policy reform within a defined 2-year budget. Our approach is built on the principle of regional ownership and sustainability, leveraging existing strengths and addressing critical gaps.

2.1. Building on Established Foundations: The Global TB Caucus Network

Unlike new initiatives that require extensive foundational work, the Hub benefits from the pre-existing, robust infrastructure of the Global TB Caucus. This network has been actively engaged in the EECA region since 2014, cultivating strong relationships and a proven track record of mobilizing political commitment for lung health. The Hub directly integrates and amplifies the work of nine active national Global TB Caucuses in Armenia, Azerbaijan, Georgia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Moldova, Tajikistan, Ukraine, and Uzbekistan. These established relationships provide an unparalleled platform for rapid engagement and impact, significantly reducing start-up time and costs.

2.2. Lean, Autonomous Regional Governance Structure

The Hub operates as an autonomous, regionally-led center, ensuring that decisions are made by and for the EECA context, while remaining strategically connected to the broader Global TB Caucus network. This lean structure is designed for agility, direct impact, and fostering regional ownership and accountability. It avoids bureaucratic overhead, allowing efficient allocation of the programme budget directly to programmatic activities.

Governance Model:

Regional Steering Committee

Composed of representatives from the Parliamentary Council, Civil Society Council, and key technical experts from the region. Provides strategic direction, oversight, and alignment with regional priorities.

Parliamentary Council

Drawing directly from the nine active national Global TB Caucuses, this council champions legislative and policy reforms, advocates for domestic resource mobilization, and ensures political buy-in at the highest levels.

Advisory Board of Former MPs (Ex-MPs)

A specialized body of former parliamentarians with deep experience in health policy and legislative processes. Provides strategic mentorship to current caucus members, leads high-level diplomatic missions, and offers a "layer of certainty" through peer-to-peer political guidance.

Civil Society Council

Representatives from key populations and civil society organizations across the EECA region, ensuring the Hub's activities are community-led, rights-based, and responsive to vulnerable populations. Provides ethical oversight – particularly for data use.

Technical Secretariat

A small, agile team responsible for day-to-day operations and implementation, built around three core leads – Parliamentary Engagement, Civil Society Engagement, and AI & Systems Architecture – plus support roles in finance, administration, and communications.

2.3. The Programme: The EECA Lung Health Hub (2-Year Program)

The Hub is a single, integrated system rather than three separate projects. The Coordination Hub provides the backbone; the Engine accelerates policy action; the Bridge aligns diplomacy and financing; and the Shield protects health system continuity under stress.

Component	Key Function	Key Deliverables (within 24 months)	Result / Value
Component 1. The Engine – Sovereignty App (AI- Powered Legislative Platform)	Turn political decisions into ready-to-table legislation and budget action, faster implementation	Secure MP Portal (role-based, invitation-only); AI-assisted drafting & amendment analysis with mandatory human review; Comparative-Law Intelligence (multi-country EECA database); automated stakeholder & timeline mapping; integrated community feedback loop; no personally identifiable data, full audit trail	Reduces routine legislative turnaround from months toward days – with traceable, governed, human-reviewed outputs
Component 2. The Bridge – AI-Driven Diplomacy & Political Coordination	Promote targeted, evidence-driven political engagement and regional cooperation instead of ad hoc efforts	Country-matching analytics (AI-assisted, human-validated); evidence-based bilateral & multilateral missions; Regional Parliamentary Summits; Decision Briefs (2–4 pages); Budget & Policy Intelligence – reviews, costing models, resource mapping, spending alignment	Turns diplomacy into a precision tool that links engagement to concrete policy and financing outcomes

Component	Key Function	Key Deliverables (within 24 months)	Result / Value
Component 3. The Shield – Health Security, Crisis Response & Continuity of Care	Keep care continuous and decision-makers informed during potential crises	Regional health-security coordination protocol; continuity-of-care mapping (aggregated, non-identifiable data); signal-based early-warning alerts for MPs; interactive dashboards (disease burden + financing); supply & last-mile visibility dashboard; privacy-by-design, aggregated indicators only	Protects continuity of care and gives early, governed warning before care is interrupted

All three components run on a shared, governed data layer – a common indicator model, interoperability standards (WHO digital-health aligned), validation/versioning, ISO 27001-grade security and sovereign / in-region hosting – which lets the Engine, Bridge and Shield share data safely.

3. THE INVESTMENT THESIS: HIGH-LEVERAGE, RAPID IMPACT FOR NATIONAL DONORS & PRIVATE PARTNERS

This programme establishes a practical, evidence-based decision-support system for lung health in EECA – designed to help governments act on evidence, spend more efficiently, and maintain system continuity during a critical transition period. With regional withdrawals in 2026, the Hub serves as a bridge to national health sovereignty, ensuring political commitments translate into sustained domestic action.

3.1. The Engine – Policy Certainty and Immediate Action

This component directly addresses one of the biggest structural gaps in the region: the absence of clear, actionable intelligence on how health resources are allocated and how policy decisions translate into financial commitments. By equipping ministries, parliaments, and national stakeholders with Budget Review Reports, Resource Mapping Analyses, Policy Costing Models, and AI-assisted legislative drafting, the Engine enables evidence-based decisions on domestic health financing, credible costing of policy options, stronger alignment between policies and national budgets, and reduced dependency on external technical assistance.

Why it's investable: It strengthens core state functions – lawmaking, budgeting, and financial analysis – linking policy intent directly to realistic fiscal commitments and helping governments reduce inefficiencies while prioritizing high-impact interventions.

Impact: Political decisions move from concept to executable, financially grounded policy within days, providing unprecedented certainty and speed.

3.2. The Bridge – Smart Diplomacy and Financing Alignment

This layer ensures regional collaboration and political engagement are no longer ad hoc, but strategically optimized through data, evidence, and structured accountability. Building on the Global TB Caucus network and by linking budget data, legislative progress, and health outcomes, the Bridge strengthens parliamentary engagement and oversight, ensures missions result in concrete policy and financing outcomes, and provides budget advocacy toolkits, oversight systems, accountability scorecards, and Legislative and Budget Impact Notes.

Why it's investable: It transforms existing political platforms from advocacy spaces into effective delivery and accountability instruments, increasing transparency and ensuring funding decisions translate into real outcomes.

Impact: Regional cooperation and parliamentary processes become precision tools for accelerating national reforms, resource optimization, and sustained implementation.

3.3. The Shield – Health Security and System Resilience

In a region facing geopolitical instability and migration pressures, this component establishes practical operational intelligence that transforms fragmented data into usable insight for planning, forecasting, and continuity of care. By integrating interactive dashboards, burden-versus-spending analyses, AI-supported forecasting models, and coordination mechanisms, the Shield protects continuity of care and prevents treatment interruptions and drug resistance, forecasts resource needs, and enables rapid, coordinated crisis response and earlier risk identification.

Why it's investable: It directly contributes to national stability, public trust, and health security by strengthening the capacity to monitor system performance, anticipate operational risks, and make coordinated resource decisions – without reliance on complex infrastructure.

Impact: Health systems become adaptive, crisis-ready, and capable of protecting vulnerable populations even in unstable conditions.

The Bottom Line: Rapid Execution and Decision Support

This is not a traditional program. It is a regional execution system that converts evidence into actionable financing and policy decisions; connects budget intelligence, operational monitoring, parliamentary accountability, and implementation tracking into one coherent system; and demonstrates a replicable model for national health sovereignty in the EECA region. Return on investment: faster, financially grounded policy implementation; stronger planning, resource optimization, and continuity of care during the funding transition; more transparent, accountable, and crisis-resilient health systems; and demonstrated decision value across 2–3 pilot countries, with a clear roadmap for regional scale.

Innovation: The Rapid Execution Cycle

The core innovation of the Hub is the full integration of the Engine, Bridge, and Shield into a single, seamless execution flow – dramatically shortening the gap between political decision and tangible implementation.

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graph LR; Decision --> Engine; Engine --> Bridge; Bridge --> Shield; Shield --> Delivered_care[Delivered care]
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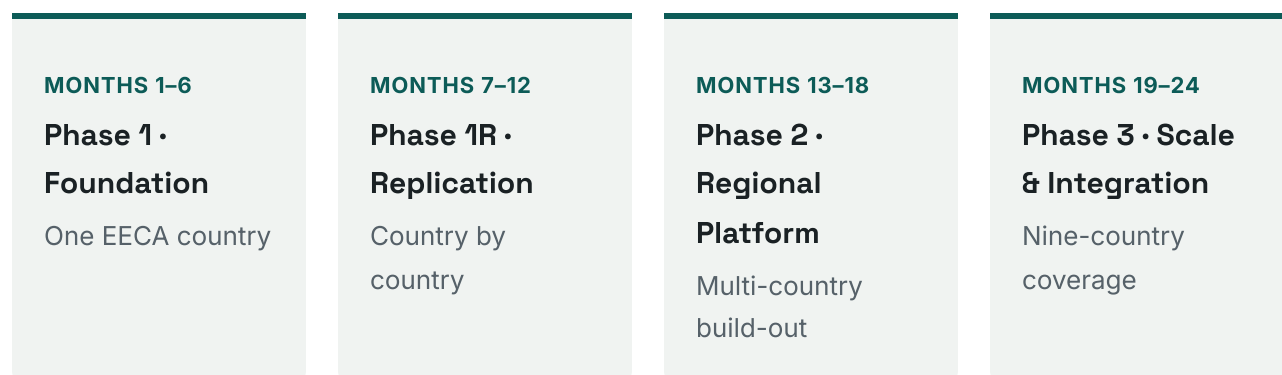
Decision → Engine → Bridge → Shield → Delivered care

- **Engine (Policy & Budget Intelligence):** An MP or ministry official drafts or amends legislation using AI-supported tools, with real-time access to budget analysis, policy costing, legal comparisons, and stakeholder input.
- **Bridge (Smart Diplomacy & Accountability):** The system identifies relevant experiences from other countries, activates targeted parliamentary engagement, and generates supporting materials (budget impact notes, advocacy briefs, accountability scorecards).
- **Shield (Operational Intelligence & Health Security):** Approved decisions are immediately translated into operational dashboards, resource forecasting, procurement signals, and continuity plans – ensuring rapid operational follow-through.

Result: A fully connected decision-to-delivery loop that compresses what traditionally takes months (or years) of fragmented efforts into a matter of weeks.

4. MECHANICS OF PROJECT IMPLEMENTATION (PHASED, 2-YEAR PROGRAMME)

The programme is implemented in phases. Each phase is independently fundable, delivers a working result on its own, and the foundation unit is designed to replicate country-by-country – a donor never funds a promise, only a repeat of something already proven.



Phase 1 – Foundation: One EECA Country (Months 1-6)

Objective: a working solution, live, after 6 months, in one country. The lead partner country is selected from the nine active national TB caucuses on criteria including

caucus readiness, political momentum, and donor fit. Delivered at Month 6: lean governance established; a Legislative Ask Map (the exact regulatory changes needed in the lead country, validated with MPs and communities); the Hub App core on sovereign infrastructure (roles/authentication, country profile, stakeholder directory, caucus workspace); a screening-intelligence dashboard with a national-reporting interoperability pilot; and a caucus legislative workplan running in the App – the proof unit.

Phase 1R – Country Replication (Months 7–12)

The identical playbook stamped into additional caucus countries, each producing its own Legislative Ask Map, dashboard and caucus workplan within 6 months. Replications run in parallel.

Phase 2 – Regional Platform Build-Out (Months 13–18)

Full Sovereignty App: Secure MP Portal, Comparative-Law Intelligence (multi-country EECA database), AI-assisted drafting & amendment analysis with mandatory human review; EN/RU multilingual rollout; hardened security posture (ISO 27001-grade, sovereign hosting); first Regional Parliamentary Summit on the platform; Decision Briefs and budget/policy intelligence production.

Phase 3 – Scale & Integration (Months 19–24)

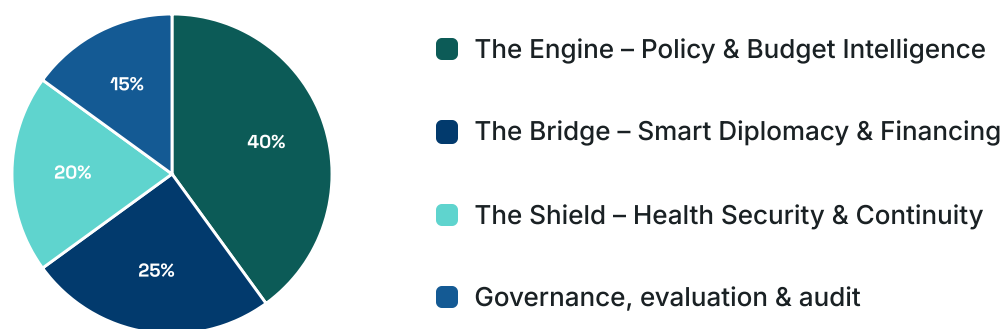
Onboard the remaining caucus countries (full nine-country coverage); full Bridge (country-matching analytics, evidence-based missions, accountability frameworks); full Shield (signal-based early warning, continuity-of-care mapping, supply & last-mile visibility dashboard; private-sector integration); comprehensive evaluation, sustainability & domestic-financing strategy, long-term institutionalization.

The components in §2.3 (Engine · Bridge · Shield) are the *what*; the phases are the *when and how much*: the Engine's core ships in Phase 1 and completes in Phase 2; the Shield's intelligence layer seeds in Phase 1 and completes in Phase 3; the Bridge operates from Phase 2 and completes in Phase 3.

WHERE THE MONEY GOES

A phased, transparent allocation.

Indicative allocation across the four programme pillars. Full line-item budget shared with partners in confidence.



Indicative allocation. Full phased budget available on request.

5. BUDGET STRUCTURE (PHASED • 24 MONTHS)

The programme is funded phase by phase. Phase 1 is a self-contained Foundation stage in one EECA country that delivers a fully working solution after 6 months; every later phase scales a proven unit. Phase 1R replicates the identical playbook country by country. Phase 2 builds out the regional platform. Phase 3 delivers nine-country coverage, full Bridge and Shield, and long-term institutionalization.

Phase 1 carries only three lines – core team, development of the solution, and a small buffer. Communications, legal/administrative work and coordination are performed by the core team within their engagement. Staff, training, multi-country rollout and maintenance for later phases are contained within the Phase 2 and Phase 3 allocations.

Full phased budget, Phase 1 line-item detail, and terms are available on request.

Please [contact us](#) or start a [consultation](#) to receive the detailed budget package.

6. CONCLUSION: A STRATEGIC INVESTMENT IN NATIONAL HEALTH AND REGIONAL STABILITY

The EECA Lung Health Hub is a focused 24-month investment to close a critical gap: turning political decisions into real delivery of care – fast – entered through a 6-month Foundation Phase in one EECA country that delivers a working solution before any further funding is asked. By integrating the Engine (AI-powered legislative platform), the Bridge (targeted political coordination), and the Shield (health security and delivery systems), the Hub creates a single execution flow from policy → financing → patient impact. Full budget and terms available on request.

Within 6 months (Phase 1), the investment delivers a live Hub App core, a national screening-intelligence dashboard connected to national reporting, the Legislative Ask Map, and an active caucus legislative workplan – a working solution in one country. Within 24 months, it delivers a fully operational Sovereignty App enabling rapid legislative action, data-driven political cooperation resulting in concrete reforms, real-time dashboards and logistics systems supporting delivery within one week for routine, templated actions in pilot settings, and protected continuity of care for 300,000+ vulnerable patients.

Why now: With the regional withdrawal of global donors in 2026, countries need practical tools to manage health systems independently. The Hub provides exactly that – speed, structure, and accountability. This is not a traditional program, but a working model of health sovereignty. We invite partners to invest in a system that delivers measurable results within two years and a scalable model beyond.

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